Euan Ripper

Engineer · Programme lead & web developer at Hack Club

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Robotics and mechatronics student at Loughborough, working as a web developer and event organiser for Hack Club. I build platforms and run programmes that have rewarded thousands of teenagers for learning technical skills. I grew up on a sustainable farm in rural Devon and care most about energy resilience and sustainability.

EXPERIENCE

Hack Club - Programme lead & web developer

United States, 2024 - present

- Selected onto a $50,000 fellowship after two interviews and a portfolio review; one of a small hand-picked group running Hack Club's funding programmes from its US headquarters. Deferred a place at Loughborough to take it.
- Led communications for Summer of Making, a global programme run with GitHub that shipped over 5,000 physical prizes to teenagers who built technical projects.
- Designed and built Beest, a full-stack web platform, from scratch: more than 4,000 verified students built projects, received feedback and earned prizes. Modelled a Strandbeest linkage in CAD and flew the top 30 builders to the Netherlands to meet Theo Jansen. One of Hack Club's first events in Europe; Net Promoter Score of 94.
- Co-created a Los Angeles hackathon with the Open Sauce team, Michael Reeves, William Osman and eight other YouTubers (combined audience around 25 million).
- Ran programmes that generated over 10,000 hours of independently verified student work; managed $100k+ budgets, logistics, event safety and deadlines to thousands of users.
- Handled a responsible security disclosure end to end: confirmed a reported email-exposure bug, took the platform offline, patched it and rewarded the reporter, then searched the logs, emailed all 25 possibly affected users, trained the developer and open-sourced the platform.

North Devon robotics club - Founder & team lead

Devon, from age 16

- Taught myself the engineering, then taught my members, growing the club from zero to 15 regular participants.
- Led the team to win the North Devon Robotics Challenge 2024 against far better-funded private schools. Credited as team lead in an IET article.

EDUCATION

Loughborough University

current

Mechatronics, robotics & control engineering

A-Levels - Mathematics, Physics, Computer Science

Queen Elizabeth's

GCSEs

Queen Elizabeth's, 2023

- Grade 9 in Computer Science, Physics, Design & Technology and English Language (with a Spoken Language distinction); grade 8 in Mathematics, Biology, Chemistry and Geography; plus Further Mathematics, English Literature and Religious Studies.

LEADERSHIP & TEAMWORK

Ten Tors 2025 - Team leader

Dartmoor, May 2025

- Led a mixed team of six from Queen Elizabeth's through the 55-mile endurance challenge, completing it in 33 hours despite record dropouts from heat stroke. Made safety calls in a heatwave and carried the team's morale; awarded the trust's student teamwork award.

European Parliament Ambassador Scheme

Strasbourg

- Addressed thousands of multinational students on the dangers of AI deepfakes, in the European Parliament building.

Deputy head boy & event organiser

Queen Elizabeth's

- Chaired student council meetings, launched a second-hand uniform shop and kept school events running; led a coding club teaching JavaScript.

INTERESTS

- Challenge-driven hobbies: unicycling (from 16), ultramarathons (first 50k finished in eight hours, at 17), learning to rollerblade at 19.
- Building in my spare time: designed and built my own walking Strandbeest; currently hacking a cheap thermal printer to print live photos from a Pi Camera.